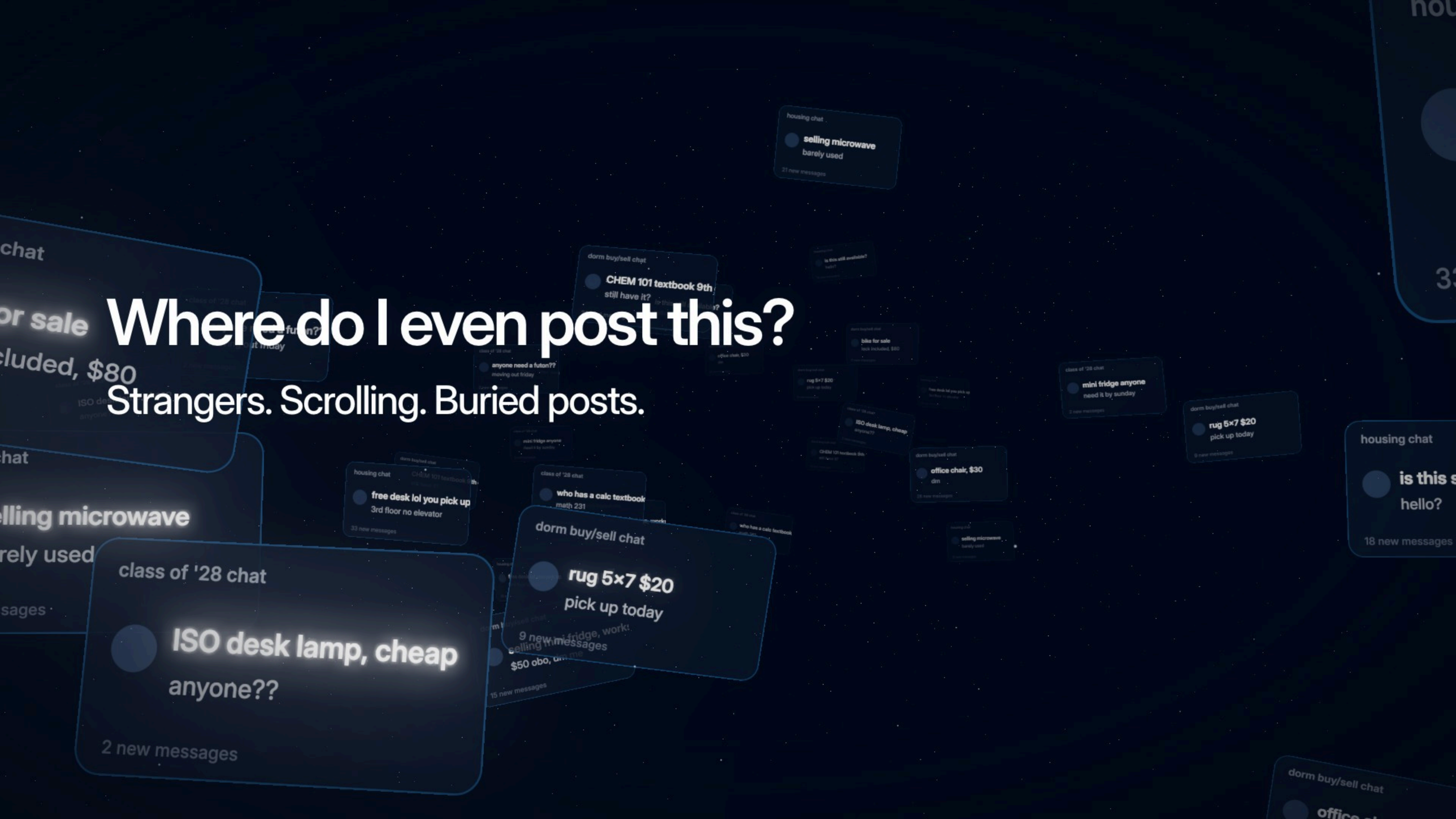


karl

the campus marketplace that lives in iMessage


Where do I even post this?
Strangers. Scrolling. Buried posts.
class of '28 chat
ISO desk lamp, cheap
anyone??
2 new messages
dorm buy/sell chat
rug 5×7 $20
pick up today
housing chat
free desk lol you pick up
3rd floor no elevator
selling microwave
barely used
mini fridge anyone
need it by sunday
office chair, $30
dm
housing chat
is this s
hello?
18 new messages

Just text. No app. No browsing.

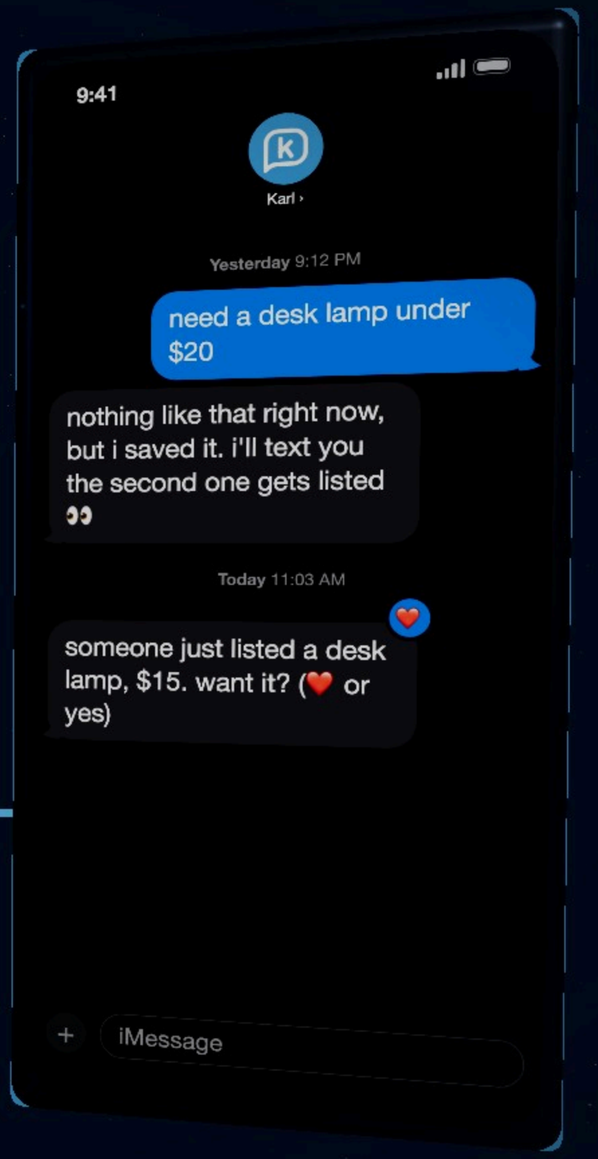


Karl texts *you* when the thing you want shows up.

Ask once. Karl keeps looking.

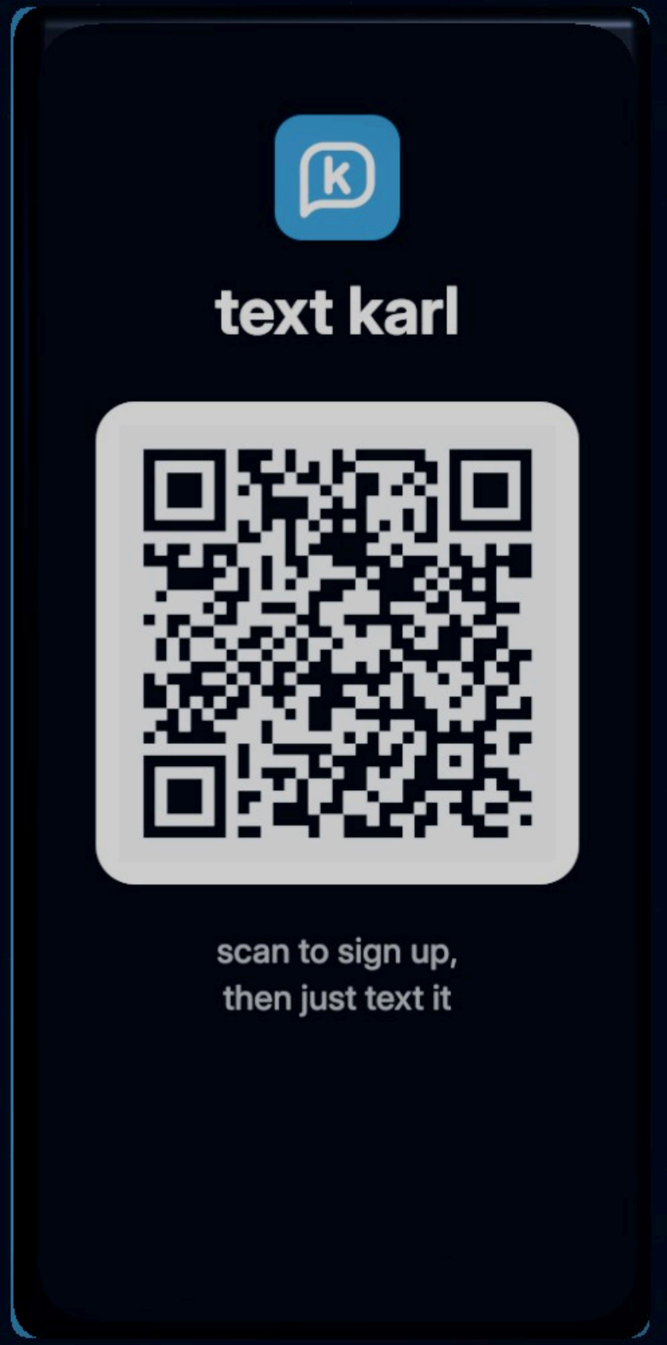
wed 11:03 am



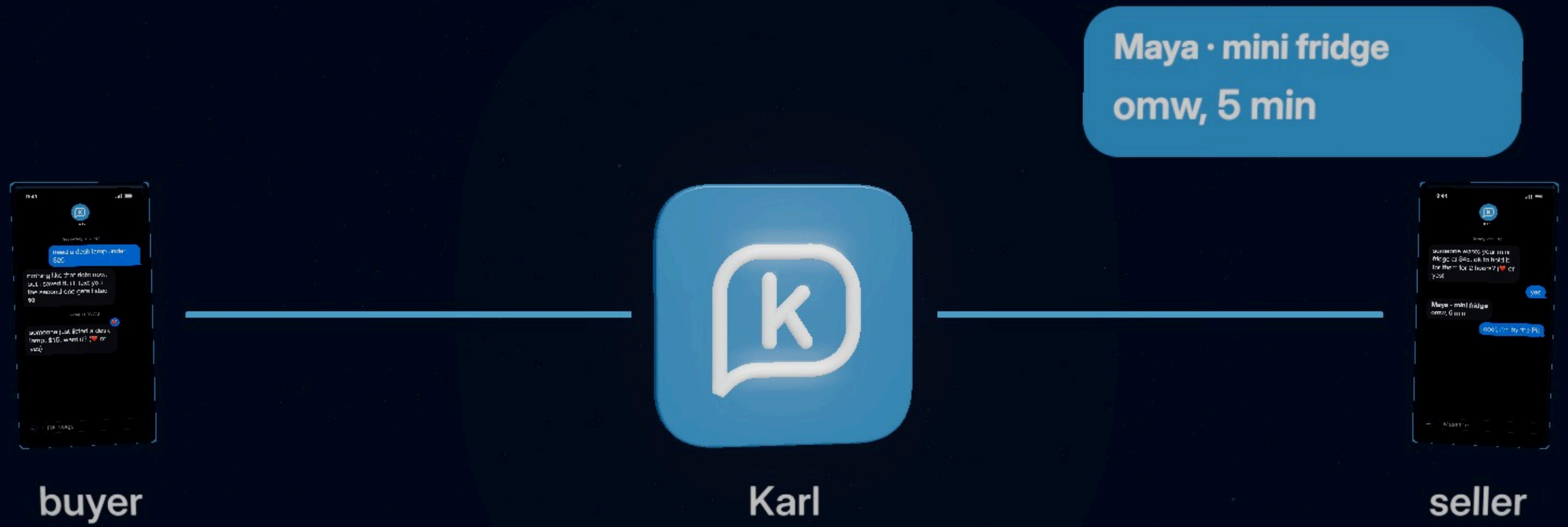


Let's try it.

live demo



Nobody's number gets shared.



buyer and seller each text Karl · Karl passes the messages along

Every message gets scanned.

heads up: only pay once you actually have the item

blocked



buyer Karl seller

pay first · deposits · pressure → **Karl warns**

numbers · links · gift cards · crypto → blocked

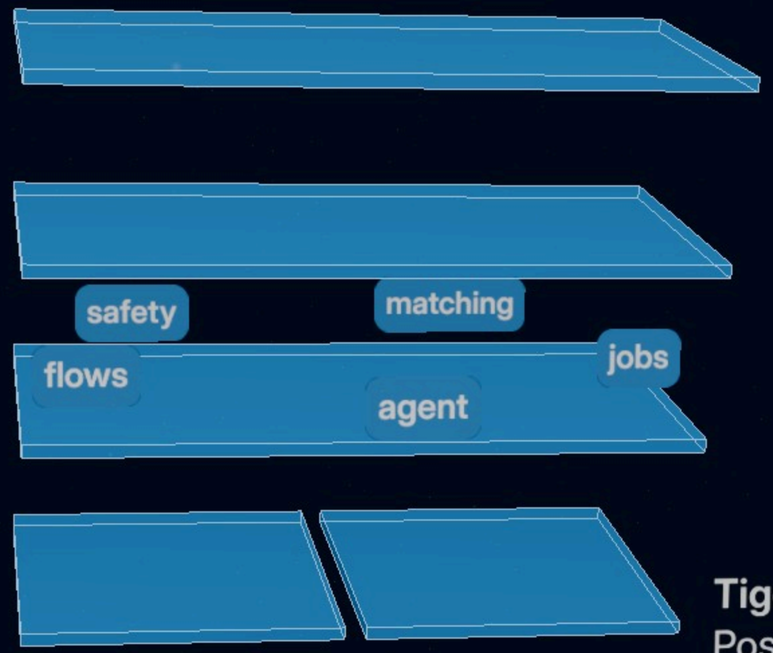
How it's built

iPhone
iMessage, no app

Photon Spectrum
real iMessage in and out

Karl server
Bun + TypeScript + Hono · Railway

Gemini
vision · tool calls · embeddings

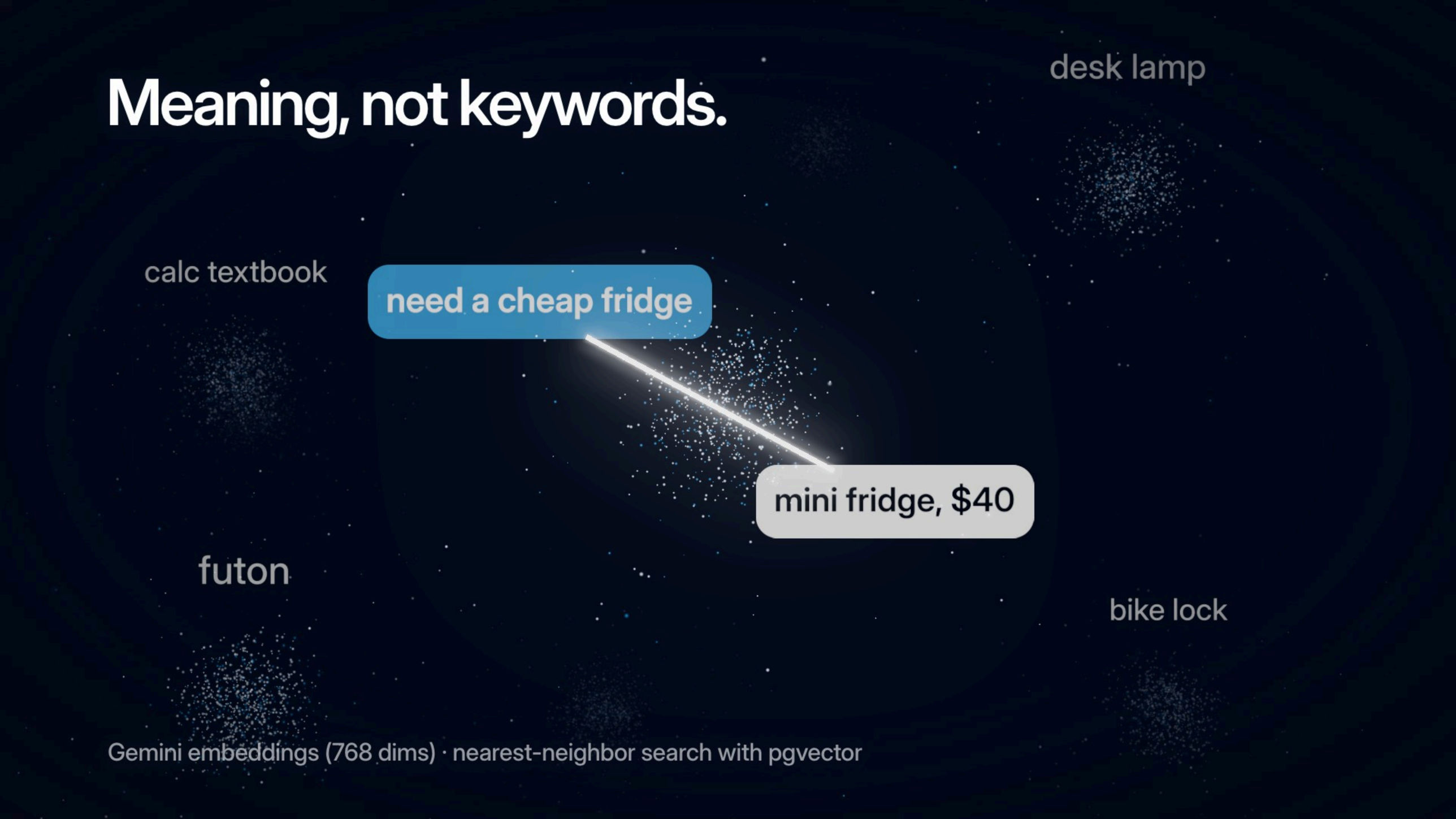


Tiger Data
Postgres · pgvector · Timescale

Gemini picks the tool. Plain code does the rest.

the AI never writes SQL, never sends texts, never routes relays

Meaning, not keywords.



Gemini embeddings (768 dims) · nearest-neighbor search with pgvector

Live at UNC right now



straight from our dashboard · Timescale continuous aggregate in Tiger Data

What's next

01 UNC email verification

02 Move-out week launch

03 Ratings

04 More campuses

tickets only if UNC policy changes



Text Karl.

the campus marketplace that lives in iMessage

scan to sign up